

Nicolas's Ocean Pedal Kayaking Playbook

A picture guide to the kayak, the water, the rules, and the joy of the ride.

Welcome, Nicolas. Today you start learning to paddle. You and your brother Alexander — two brothers, one harbor, one big sport you can love your whole life. The plan: **learn it on land first.** Every part of the kayak. The PFD. The weather. The tide. The dock. Then — when you know the words and the parts and the pieces — we go on the water. Kayaking is not about being fast. It's about reading the water, taking care of your kayak, and being a smart paddler. Take your time. Look at the pictures. Watch a video. Practice a skill on the dock.

What's inside this playbook



The Kayak

A picture map of a pedal kayak — bow, stern, pedals, rudder, paddle. Every part labeled.



Rules & Safety

10 ocean safety rules. PFD always. Check the marine forecast. Stay near shore. Watch the tide. The basics that keep you safe.



Skills & Moves

Pedaling. Steering with the rudder. Stopping. The paddle stroke. Self-rescue. The moves every paddler knows.



Lesson Plans

Four lesson formats. From calm-water basics in Sippican Harbor to real trips along the bay.



Fun Games

Brother games. Buoy-to-buoy race. Treasure hunt. Things to play on the water.



Your Ocean Pedal Kayaking Story

A picture story about a kayaking day — what to expect, what to do, what to feel.

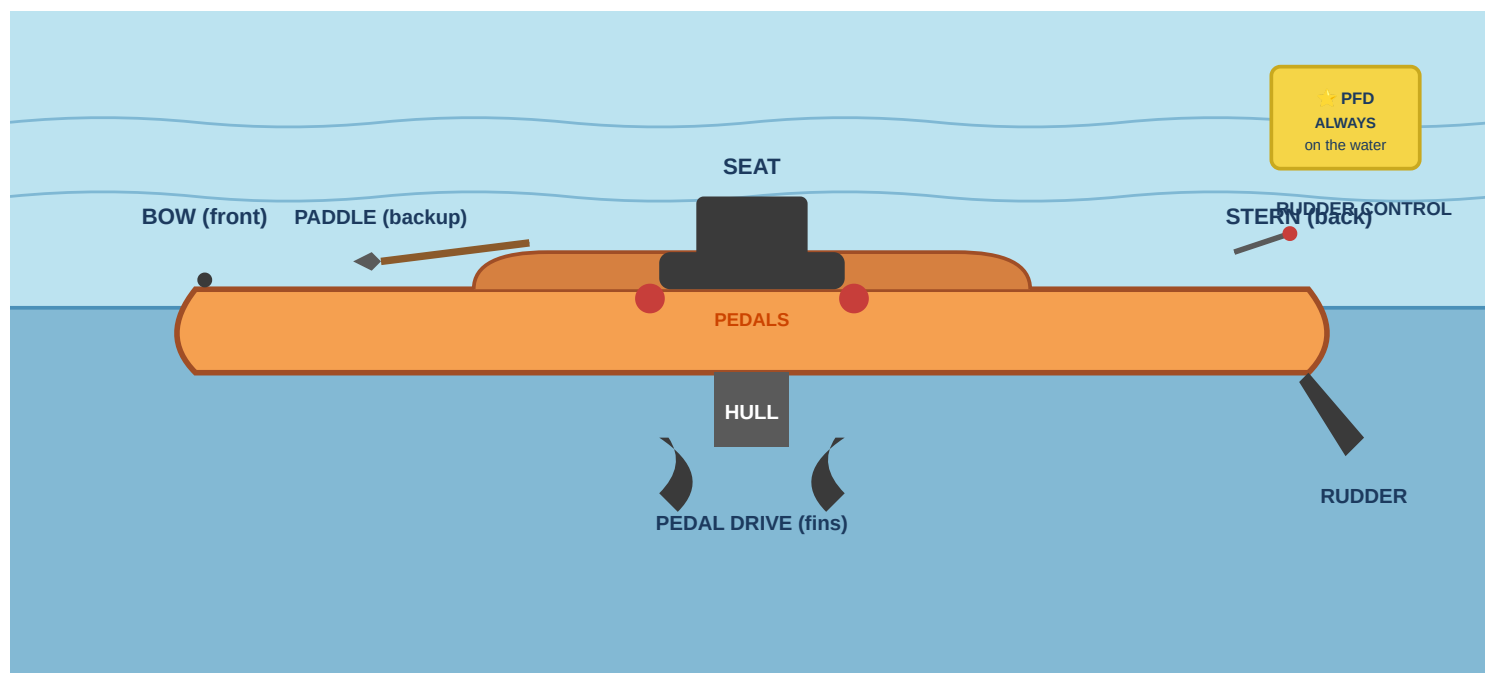


Ocean Pedal Kayaking Songs

Custom Suno songs made just for you. Listen before a paddle to get ready, or after a great trip on the water.

" The ocean doesn't care if you're new. It just is. Learn to read it, and the ocean will take you anywhere a kayak can go. "

A pedal kayak is a boat you drive with your *FEET* — like a bike on the water. There's still a paddle, but the pedal drive does most of the work. Every part has a name and a job.



The parts and what they do

PFD ★

Personal Flotation Device — your life jacket. Coast Guard approved, fits snug, ZIPPED UP. EVERY ride. No exceptions.

💬 "Life jacket first."

Bow

The FRONT of the kayak. Pointy end goes first.

💬 "Pointy end forward."

Stern

The BACK of the kayak. Where the rudder lives.

💬 "Where you steer from."

Hull

The body of the kayak. Sits ON the water. Strong plastic.

💬 "The skin of the kayak."

Seat

Adjustable. Should be snug. Back support keeps your spine happy on long rides.

💬 "Snug seat."

Pedals

Like bike pedals. PUSH with your feet in cycles. The pedals turn the fins under the kayak.

💬 "Push and pedal."

Pedal drive (fins)

Under the kayak. Wag back and forth like a fish's tail. THIS is what pushes you forward.

💬 "Like a fish tail."

Rudder

A small fin under the back. Hand control turns it left or right. Steers WITHOUT slowing you down.

💬 "Hand controls direction."

Paddle

The backup. Use it when you start, when you stop, in shallow water, or as a brake. Always keep it ON the kayak.

💬 "Backup. Always there."

Bow handle

A strap or handle at the front for carrying.

💬 "For carrying."

Ocean kayaking grows with you

Ocean kayaking has stages. Each one opens up new water. There is no rush. Every paddler started on calm water.



Calm Water Stage

What you learn here: getting in and out, sitting balanced, pedaling, steering with the rudder. Sippican Harbor on a still morning. Tandem with Daddy.

💬 "Calm water. Snug PFD."



Harbor Stage

What you learn here: sharing the harbor with kayaks and motorboats. Reading wind and waves. Longer trips. Snack stops on a beach.

💬 "Eyes up, scan the harbor."



Bay Stage

What you learn here: small open water (inner Buzzards Bay). Currents and tides. Spotting weather changes. Real trips with goals.



"Plan the trip. Read the bay."



Paddler Stage

What you learn here: longer ocean trips. Reading charts. Self-rescue. Paddling with friends. Your kayak takes you to places only paddlers go.



"My boat. My route."

Watch & learn



Pedal Kayak for Beginners

An intro to how pedal kayaks work and how to get started.

▶ Watch



Kayak Safety for Kids

PFD fit, water safety basics, and what to do if you tip over.

▶ Watch

Ocean kayaking has clear rules — most of them about safety. The ocean is bigger and stronger than you. The rules keep you safe so you can keep paddling for the rest of your life.



1. PFD on, every time

Personal Flotation Device. Coast Guard-approved. Zipped up. Snug enough that you can't pull it over your head. EVERY time you get in the kayak. Even at the dock.

 *"PFD first. Always."*

 Watch



2. Check the weather BEFORE you go

Wind forecast (under 10 mph for kids). Wave forecast (under 1 foot). Storm warnings (no go). Marine forecast — not just regular weather.

 *"Marine forecast first."*

 Watch



3. Tell someone where you're going

Before you launch: tell someone on land where you'll go and when you'll be back. This is called a "float plan."

 *"Float plan to a person."*

 Watch



4. Stay near the shore

At your stage, ALWAYS stay within sight of land. Most rides keep the shore within a few hundred yards. The ocean is BIG.

 *"Land always in sight."*

 Watch



5. Watch the tide

Tides go IN and OUT every 6 hours. Paddling AGAINST a strong outgoing tide is tiring. Plan to leave WITH the tide and return WITH the tide.

 "Go with the tide."

 Watch



6. Watch for boats

Bigger boats can't see you easily. Stay out of channel markers. Look BOTH ways before crossing a channel — like crossing a street.

 "Look both ways."

 Watch



7. Cold water = real danger

In Massachusetts, ocean water is COLD until July (and after September). Cold water can shock the body fast. Wear a wetsuit or stay out when it's cold.

 "Cold = real risk."

 Watch



8. If you tip — STAY WITH THE KAYAK

If you fall out, DO NOT swim away. Hold on to the kayak. It floats. The kayak is your best safety device. Wait for help.

 "Stay with the kayak."

 Watch



9. Carry a way to call for help

Phone in a waterproof case. Or a whistle (3 short blasts = SOS). Best to have both.

"Whistle + phone."

▶ Watch



10. Be a great paddler

Wave to other kayakers. Help if someone needs it. Don't paddle close to people's boats or docks. Leave no trash.

"Wave. Help. Leave it clean."

▶ Watch

▶ Watch

"The ocean does not care if you're tired. The rules are not to slow you down — they're what let you come back to the water every summer, for the rest of your life."

Watch & learn the rules

Short videos that explain how the game is played. Watch a couple before your first session.



Ocean Kayak Safety

▶ Watch



Pedal Kayak Tutorial

▶ Watch



Reading Marine Forecast

▶ Watch



Tides for Paddlers

▶ Watch

Every move in a kayak has a name and a feel. Some you do with your feet (pedaling), some with your hands (rudder, paddle), some with your whole body (sitting balanced).

The 6 essential moves



Pedaling forward

Push DOWN on each pedal in alternation, like a bike. Smooth even circles. Don't stomp. Let your legs do the work — not your back.

💬 "Smooth. Even. Steady."

▶ Watch



Backing up

Most pedal drives reverse — pedal BACKWARDS. Or use the paddle: short reverse strokes at the bow.

💬 "Reverse the pedal."

▶ Watch



Steering with rudder

The hand control turns the rudder. Push the control LEFT to go LEFT. RIGHT to go RIGHT. Gentle moves. Don't over-steer.

💬 "Gentle hand."

▶ Watch



Stopping

Stop pedaling. The kayak will glide. To stop FASTER: use the paddle as a brake (hold it in the water alongside the kayak).

💬 "Glide. Or paddle-brake."

▶ Watch



Sitting balanced

Sit UPRIGHT, not slouched. Center your weight. If the kayak rocks, MOVE WITH IT — don't fight it. Loose hips, calm breath.

 "Loose hips. Calm breath."

 Watch



Paddle stroke (backup)

Hold the paddle with hands shoulder-width apart. Reach forward, plant the blade in the water, PULL back along the kayak. Switch sides.

 "Reach, plant, pull."

 Watch

 Watch

The PFD Check (every ride)

The 4-Point check:

- **Zipped** — fully zipped to the top.
- **Buckled** — all clips snapped.
- **Snug** — can't pull it over your head when lifted by the shoulders.
- **Fit** — Coast Guard size matches your body weight (label on the inside).

 "Zipped. Buckled. Snug. Fit."

Getting In and Out (the safe way)

From a beach or dock — the brace method:

- Kayak in the water, floating, pointed parallel to shore.
- ONE hand on the seat, ONE on the dock (or sand).
- Step into the COCKPIT first with the foot closest to the kayak.
- Lower butt down to the seat SLOWLY.
- Bring the other foot in. Adjust pedals. Snug PFD. Go.

 *"Brace. Step. Sit. Adjust."*

If You Tip Over (the wet exit)

If the kayak flips — DON'T PANIC:

- Your PFD will bring you to the surface. Breathe.
- Hold on to the kayak — DO NOT swim away from it.
- If close to shore: swim the kayak to shore.
- If far from shore: stay with the kayak, blow your whistle (3 short blasts), wait for help.
- If you can, try to flip the kayak upright. Climb back in from the SIDE, bracing with both hands.

 *"Stay calm. Stay with the kayak."*

*The structure stays the same so you can predict what's coming. The content inside the structure changes so it never gets boring. Four trip formats roll in over the year — starting with **land only** for the first 6 weeks. Each scales to a 60-min trip with Coach or a 30-min practice with Daddy. BYC Junior Kayaking runs in the summer — the rest of the year, the land formats keep you sharp.*

Why formats, not single-skill weeks

Kayaking has SO many parts. Boat parts. Knots. Wind directions. Maneuvers. If we tried to learn one thing per week, you'd forget the first by the time we got to the fifth. Instead, every practice follows the same shape: warm up → boat check → new skill → practice → game → pack up. The shape is the constant. What goes inside each block is what evolves. Every part you learn this week shows up next week in a different combination — it never disappears.

Built-in transitions (PFD check, water break, knot drill on the dock) are **part of the practice**, not interruptions. They reset attention between blocks. Plan for them.

The Four Formats

One format starts. A second is added at week 7. A third at week 27. A fourth at week 40. After each addition, formats *rotate* — never converge.

"Look at this. Let's name it."

FORMAT A · LAND DISCOVERY

Weeks 1–6 (only format used) · Then in rotation through week 52

Foundation building. **No water yet.** The first six weeks happen entirely on land — at home, in the yard, in the kayak shed. Touch every part of the kayak. Tie knots. Push the dolly. Watch the wind in the trees. By the time you launch, the kayak will feel like an old friend.

With Coach

60 min

8 min Warm Up

Body wake-up + 2 moves from the warm-up menu (e.g., boat walk + knot drill).

☞ "Wake up the body."

8 min Boat Touch

Walk around the kayak. Touch every part. Name it out loud. Bow, stern, mast, boom...

☞ "Touch it. Name it."

10 min New Skill Preview

Watched the video at home? Looked at the picture? Now Coach names it, demos it, you try slowly.

☞ "Watch. Then try."

10 min Practice with the New Skill

Put it into a drill or activity. Getting ready step. Knot speed. Wind detective.

☞ "Now use it."

10 min Drill

Focused repetition. Coach times you tying a bowline. You build muscle memory.

☞ "Reps build it."

8 min Favorite Game

With Daddy

30 min

5 min Warm Up

1 move from the menu.

☞ "Wake up the body."

6 min Boat Touch

Touch and name 5 parts. Quick.

☞ "Touch it. Name it."

7 min Skill

Revisit or preview. Quick.

☞ "Watch. Then try."

7 min Drill or Game

Knot race, parts hunt, or wind check.

☞ "Now use it."

5 min Pack Up

Tools, water, gear. Same exit ritual.

☞ "Pack up. Water. Thank you."

End on a high. Pick from the games list.

💬 *"End on a high."*

5 min

Pack Up

Tools away, water, exit ritual (high-five, "thank you").

💬 *"Pack up. Water. Thank you."*

"Boat in the water. I'm kayaking."

FORMAT B · DOCK & PADDLE

Introduced Week 7 · Alternates with A through week 26

Now the kayak goes in the water. Get it ready. Push it down the ramp. Climb in. Paddle away from the dock. Paddle back. The work happens on land too — getting ready, checking — but now the reward is a real trip on the water. Daddy is in the chase kayak. You're the paddler.

With Coach

60 min

8 min Warm Up

2 menu moves. Add a knot speed drill + a wind check on the dock.

☞ "Wake up the body."

12 min Rig Up

Build the kayak from scratch with Coach. Every step named. PFD on first.

☞ "Build the kayak."

5 min Check

PFD zipped? Drain plug in? Lines clear? Coach signs off.

☞ "Check before launch."

20 min Paddle

Launch. Paddle one direction, then back. Daddy in the chase kayak nearby.

☞ "This is the best part."

10 min Pack Up

Pull kayak up. Rinse. Stash paddle. Strap on the rack. Kayak to bed.

☞ "Boat to bed."

With Daddy

30 min

5 min Warm Up

1–2 menu moves + a knot.

☞ "Wake up the body."

10 min Rig Practice

Get the kayak ready together on the dolly. Practice the steps. Not launching today.

☞ "Build the kayak."

10 min Pack Up

Rinse with fresh water. Stash paddle. Strap on the rack. Same routine every time.

☞ "Boat to bed."

5 min Pack Up

Tools, water, gear.

☞ "Pack up. Water. Thank you."

5 min

Exit Ritual

High five. "Good paddle." "Thanks, Daddy."

💬 *"Pack up. Water. Thank you."*

"I can turn the kayak. I can tip over and get back up."

FORMAT C · OPEN WATER

Introduced Week 27 · Rotates with A and B through week 39

Real kayaking skills. Reading wind. Reading waves. Self-rescue. Paddling further from the dock. Daddy gives you specific challenges. You feel the water. You make the kayak go where you want.

With Coach

60 min

8 min

Warm Up

Menu moves + a few dry-land paddle strokes (no kayak) and a PFD drill.

☞ "Wake up the body."

8 min

Rig + Brief

Get the kayak ready. Daddy previews today's challenge: "Today, 5 clean turns in a row." Walk through it on the dock.

☞ "See it. Then paddle it."

15 min

Skill Drill

Specific drill — turn box (paddle a square), self-rescue practice, reading headings.

☞ "One piece at a time."

15 min

Open Paddle

Apply the skill in a real paddle. Daddy calls course changes. You execute.

☞ "Real paddling."

8 min

Champion Moment

End with a favorite — a smooth glide, a clean turn, a perfect docking.

☞ "End on a win."

6 min

Pack Up

Pack up. Boat to bed.

☞ "Boat to bed."

With Daddy

30 min

5 min

Warm Up

1–2 menu moves + a knot.

☞ "Wake up the body."

10 min

Skill Review

Walk through today's skill on land.

Dry-land paddle strokes. PFD drill.

Weather check.

☞ "One piece at a time."

10 min

Watch & Talk

Watch a clip of yourself from Coach's trip. Name one thing that went well.

☞ "Real paddling."

5 min

Pack Up

Same exit ritual.

☞ "Pack up. Water. Thank you."

"I am a paddler. This is my wind."

FORMAT D · PADDLER

Introduced Week 40 · Rotates with A, B, and C through week 52

Ownership and reflection. You choose your warm-up moves. You pick one skill you want to refine. You paddle a course you and Daddy set. And at the end, you watch a short clip or name one win and one challenge — the metacognitive frame that real paddlers build.

With Coach

60 min

8 min Warm Up — Your Choice

You pick 2 moves from the menu. Call them out.

💬 "I pick today."

12 min Technical Tune-Up

"What do you want to work on today?"
Turning? Balance? Self-rescue? You choose.

💬 "Make my best better."

12 min Tactical Challenge

A paddle with one specific rule —
"every turn under 5 seconds" or
"paddle the whole leg without using
the rudder hard."

💬 "One rule. One paddle."

15 min Course Paddle

A short course around two buoys.
Maybe a fun race. Real kayaking
decisions.

💬 "Paddle it real."

8 min Reflect

Watch a 30-second clip Coach filmed.
Name one win. Name one challenge
for next time.

💬 "What did I learn?"

5 min Pack Up

With Daddy

30 min

5 min Warm Up — Choice

You pick your moves.

💬 "I pick today."

10 min Tune-Up

One skill you want to work on (on land
or at the dock).

💬 "Make my best better."

10 min Watch & Plan

Watch your clip from Coach. Plan one
thing to try next time.

💬 "What did I learn?"

5 min Pack Up

Same exit ritual.

💬 "Pack up. Water. Thank you."

Same exit ritual.

💬 *"Pack up. Water. Thank you."*

The Warm-Up Menu

These are the foundation moves. They never go away. They live in the warm-up of every format, every session — picking 1–3 each time, rotating through. New foundation moves get added; old ones fade and return.

★ PFD Check

Zipped. Buckled. Snug. Right size. Every ride.

💬 *"Zipped. Buckled. Snug."*

☀️ Marine Forecast Check

Wind under 10 mph. Waves under 1 foot. No storms in the next 3 hours. If not — postpone.

💬 *"Marine forecast first."*

🦋 Body Wake-Up

Arm circles, leg swings, hip openers, ankle circles. 30 seconds each.

💬 *"Wake the body."*

🛶 Kayak Check

Pedals smooth? Rudder moves left and right? Paddle clipped on? Plug in?

💬 *"Pedals. Rudder. Paddle. Plug."*

🚀 Dock Launch Drill

Practice the brace-step-sit-adjust sequence ON LAND first. Then in shallow water.

💬 *"Brace. Step. Sit. Adjust."*

🦶 Slow Pedal

Pedal at half speed. Smooth circles. Both feet doing equal work.

💬 *"Smooth. Equal."*

🔄 Rudder Practice

While pedaling slow, gently push the rudder control left. Then right. Notice how the kayak turns.

💬 *"Gentle hand."*

🐟 Spot Something

Look for one thing in the water: a fish, a seagull, a piece of seaweed. Builds eyes-up habit.

💬 *"Eyes up. See it."*

🛑 Stop Practice

Pedal forward. Daddy says "STOP!" Stop pedaling. Glide. Then dip the paddle in as a brake.

💬 *"Stop. Glide. Brake."*

Look Around

Slowly turn your head all the way left. All the way right. Look behind. Builds situational awareness.

 "360 view."

The 52-Week Plan

A year of kayaking. The format rotates. The skills build. Each week has a focus and a video. Skip ahead if a piece clicks fast. Repeat any week as needed. **BYC Junior Kayaking happens in summer** — phases 2–4 are designed around that. The off-season is for knots, dry-getting ready, and watching the wind in your own backyard.

Phase 1 • Discover the Kayak

Format A only. No water yet. Every part, every knot, every wind direction — on land.

WEEK 1

Discover the Kayak

Touch each part of the kayak: bow, stern, hull, seat, pedals, rudder, paddle. Name them out loud.

WEEK 2

PFD Fitting

The 4-point PFD check. Zipped, buckled, snug, right size. Practice until it's second nature.

WEEK 3

Getting In & Out

The brace-step-sit-adjust sequence. On dry land first. Then very shallow water with Daddy holding the kayak.

WEEK 4

Discover Pedaling

Smooth even circles with the feet. In a sheltered cove. 50 yards straight in calm water.

WEEK 5

Discover Steering

The rudder control — gentle moves. Turn in a big lazy circle. Then a smaller one.

WEEK 6

Discover Stopping

Stop pedaling, glide. Then paddle-brake. Aim to stop at a buoy.

Phase 2 · Adding Paddling Skills

Formats A & B alternate. Getting the kayak ready. Paddling away from the dock. The first real trips on the water.

WEEK 7 A

Backing Up

Reverse pedaling. Slow and controlled. Practice backing into a dock.

WEEK 8 B

Dock Approach & Departure

Pull up to a dock, hold position, push off smoothly. Repeat.

WEEK 9 A

Paddle Stroke

Forward paddle stroke. Reach, plant, pull. Hands shoulder-width.

WEEK 10 B

Pedal + Paddle Combo

Pedal AND paddle for extra speed. Then paddle alone in shallow water.

WEEK 11 A

Sweep Strokes

A wide arcing paddle stroke to turn. Useful when the rudder isn't enough.

WEEK 12 B

Turn Race

Two buoys. Pedal around one, sweep-stroke around the other. Time it.

WEEK 13 A

Reading Wind

Wind blows your kayak around. Notice which way. Pedal slightly INTO the wind.

WEEK 14 B

Wind Drill

Daddy calls wind direction. Paddle on different headings. Notice how each feels.

WEEK 15 A

Reading Waves

Waves come from a direction. POINT INTO waves. Sideways = unstable.

WEEK 16 B

Wave Practice

In light chop, point the bow at oncoming waves. Notice the stability.

WEEK 17 A

Self-Rescue Basics

If you tip, stay with the kayak. Practice "hold and signal" in shallow water with Daddy.

WEEK 18 B

Whistle Drill

3 short blasts = SOS. Practice. Make sure whistle is clipped to the PFD.

WEEK 19 **A**

Reading Tides

Outgoing = water flows out. Incoming = in. Plan around them.

WEEK 20 **B**

Tide Walk

Look at a tide chart together. Pick an incoming-tide window. Then go.

WEEK 21 **A**

Channel Crossing

Stop. Look both ways. Cross at 90°. Don't dawdle.

WEEK 22 **B**

Channel Drill

Approach a real channel with Daddy. Practice the look-both-ways routine.

WEEK 23 **A**

Long-Distance Pace

A smooth efficient pace you can hold for an hour. Not too fast.

WEEK 24 **B**

One-Hour Ride

First hour-long paddle. Snack and water at the halfway mark.

WEEK 25 **A**

Landing on a Beach

Approach with bow forward, slow down, ride the last wave in.

WEEK 26 **B**

Sippican Harbor Tour

End-of-phase celebration. Full harbor tour. Land at a beach for lunch.

Phase 3 · Adding Real Trips

Formats A, B, C rotate. Jibing for real. Kayaking on every point. Tip over is normal now.

WEEK 27 **C**

First Real Trip

Format C debuts. Plan a route. Pack snacks. Float plan. Go.

WEEK 28 **A**

Reading the Sky

Dark clouds = potential storm. Wind picking up = head back. Trust your gut.

WEEK 29 **B**

Weather Awareness

Point out clouds, wind direction, sun position while paddling.

WEEK 30 **C**

Buoy-to-Buoy Trip

Pick 3 buoys in the harbor. Make a route. Stop at each.

WEEK 31 **A**

Anchoring

How to drop a small anchor to stay in one spot. For snack, swim, fishing.

WEEK 32 **B**

Drift & Anchor

Quiet cove. Drop anchor. Eat lunch. Pull anchor. Continue.

WEEK 33 **C**

Cove Hopping

Visit 3 different beaches/coves in Sippican Harbor. Land at each.

WEEK 34 **A**

Towing a Friend

How to tow another kayak with a tow line clipped to the stern.

WEEK 35 **B**

Tow Drill

Practice towing Daddy's kayak — no distress, just practice.

WEEK 36 **C**

Sunset Paddle

Evening trip. Calm water. Magic light. Back before dark.

WEEK 37 **A**

Bigger Water Awareness

Beyond the harbor: calm forecast, low waves, Daddy along, float plan. Bay-edge only.

WEEK 38 **B**

Bay-Edge Trip

Brief venture beyond the harbor mouth — to the bay edge. Then back.

WEEK 39 **C**

Buzzards Bay Day

End-of-phase celebration. Calm-day trip along the inner Buzzards Bay shore.

Phase 4 • Becoming a Paddler

All four formats rotate. Course racing. Reflection. The full sport.

WEEK 40 **D**

I Plan the Route

Format D debuts. Nicolas picks the route. Looks at the chart. Plans the float plan.

WEEK 41 **A**

Chart Reading Basics

Reading a marine chart. Depth marks. Hazards. Channel markers. Buoy numbers.

WEEK 42 **B**

Chart Walk

Spread the chart on the floor. Trace a route. Note hazards.

WEEK 43 **C**

Multi-Stop Trip

3 stops. Chart-planned route. Thermos along. Real trip.

WEEK 44 **D**

I Lead the Trip

Nicolas leads, Daddy follows. Calls hazards. Makes decisions.

WEEK 45 **A**

Fishing from the Kayak

Hands free. Stealth approach. Cast and reel from the seat.

WEEK 46 **B**

First Fishing Trip

Quiet cove. Goal: be on the water with a line, not necessarily catch.

WEEK 47 **C**

Group Paddle

Invite a cousin or friend. Single file. Stay together.

WEEK 48 **D**

Self-Rescue Practice

Warm calm day. Tip on purpose. Get back in. Daddy spotting.

WEEK 49 **A**

Kayak Camping Concepts

How to pack for an overnight. Dry bags. Where to camp.

WEEK 50 **B**

Pack-and-Paddle

Pack the kayak as if for overnight. Paddle a normal route with the extra weight.

WEEK 51 **C**

Big Day Trip

Best trip of the year. Long day on the water. Lunch on a beach.

WEEK 52 **D**

Kayaking Birthday

Year-end. Reflect: 3 favorite trips. Set a goal for Year 2. Celebrate.

Drills get the body strong. Games get the spirit strong. Mix them in every paddle. Some work great solo. Some work better with Daddy nearby. Some are perfect when Alexander joins.



Buoy-to-Buoy Race **CLASSIC**

The Sippican Harbor classic. Pick 3 buoys in a triangle. Pedal to each in order, touch (don't crash), pedal to the next. Time it. Beat your time next week.

Why it's perfect for the brothers: built-in regulation (each buoy is a rest point), no winner-vs-loser (you race the clock), Daddy can be the timer in a chase kayak, and Alexander can pick the triangle one week, Nicolas the next.

💬 "Buoy. Touch. Next."



Slow Race

LAST to finish wins. Pedal as slowly as you can without stopping. Builds balance and patience.

💬 "Slower is harder."

▶ Watch



Paddle Race

No pedals. Just paddle. 50 yards. Builds the backup skill so it's ready when you need it.

💬 "Reach, plant, pull."

▶ Watch



Rudder Slalom

Set up 5 floating markers (water balloons, lobster buoys). Weave through them using only the rudder. No paddle.

💬 "Gentle hand. Smooth turns."

▶ Watch



Cove-to-Cove Relay

Pick 2 small beaches. Pedal from one to the other. Touch the shore. Come back. Time it.

 *"Touch the sand."*

 Watch



Treasure Hunt

Daddy makes a list ("a red buoy, a sea bird, a jellyfish, a moored sailboat"). Pedal around. Find them all.

 *"Eyes wide. Find them."*

 Watch



Echo Game

Quiet on the water. Listen for one minute. Name every sound: wind, water, boats, birds. Calming.

 *"Stop. Listen."*

 Watch



Fishing from the Kayak

Bring a simple rod. Pedal to a quiet spot. Drop a line. The goal is just being out there with a line in the water.

 *"Quiet hands. Patient line."*

 Watch



Boat Spotter

Pedal around the harbor. How many different boat types can you name? Sailboat, motorboat, kayak, paddleboard, lobster boat, jet ski.

 "Name what you see."

 Watch



Sunrise / Sunset Quiet Paddle

No game. No racing. Just paddle slowly in the magic light. Talk OR be quiet. Both are fine.

 "Slow. Look around."

 Watch



Wake Riding (safe)

When a motorboat goes by FAR away, the waves reach you. Point INTO them. Let the kayak rise and fall. Fun.

 "Bow into the wave."

 Watch



Compass Practice

Daddy says "Pedal north!" Then "Pedal east!" Use the sun or a compass to find each direction.

 "Find north first."

 Watch

 Watch

Watch fun kayak games in action



Kid-Friendly Kayak Activities

Fun on-water games for families.

▶ Watch



Pedal Kayak Fishing for Kids

First fishing trips from a pedal kayak.

▶ Watch

Make any paddle more fun

- **Add a story.** "You're exploring an island no one has visited. Map it."
- **Add silly cues.** "Pedal like a sea turtle. Smooth. Steady. Wise."
- **Add a target.** A specific beach, a specific buoy. A goal makes the paddle a journey.
- **Add a snack stop.** Mid-paddle beach landing. Apples taste better on a beach you paddled to.
- **Add a name.** Give the kayak a name. "She" or "he" — the kayak has a personality.
- **Add music or quiet.** Some days music. Some days just water and wind. Both are perfect.

▶ Watch

*A picture story about a day at BYC Junior Kayaking. Read it with Mom or Dad before practice.
Read it again whenever you want. The pictures show what to expect. The words show what to do.*

Nicolas Goes Kayaking

A story about my day at BYC



PAGE 1

My name is Nicolas. I am a paddler.



PAGE 2

Today is my kayaking day. I will paddle with Daddy and my brother Alexander.



PAGE 3

I pack my bag. PFD. Water bottle. Hat. Sunscreen. Towel. I am ready.



PAGE 4

We drive to BYC. I look at the water. I look at the trees — to see which way the wind is blowing.



PAGE 5

First thing — PFD on. Zipped. Snug. Coach will check it.



PAGE 6

I see Coach. Coach says "Hi Nicolas!" I can say hi back, or wave, or smile.



PAGE 7

We get the kayak ready on the dock. PFD on. Paddle clipped. Pedals checked. I know every part.



PAGE 8

I push the kayak on the dolly. Walking feet on the dock. Slow and steady.



PAGE 9

The boat goes in the water. I climb in. The boat moves under me — that is normal. The water is my home now.



PAGE 10

I push the pedals. The kayak starts to glide. I am kayaking.



PAGE 11

If I feel scared — or if water splashes me — I take a deep breath. Coach is right there. I am safe.



PAGE 12

Sometimes the kayak tips over. That is called tip over. It happens to every paddler. I stay with the kayak. I stand on the centerboard. I climb back in.



PAGE 13

I paddle back to the dock. I touch the dock. I climb out. I did it!



PAGE 14

We rinse the kayak. Strap it back on the rack. Then high-five Daddy. "Thank you, Daddy!"



PAGE 15

Kayaking makes me strong. Kayaking makes me brave. Kayaking makes me happy. I am a paddler.

" Capsizing is part of kayaking. Learning is part of kayaking. Showing up is part of kayaking. You belong on the water. "

Music is part of paddling. Songs help you preview what's coming, regulate your body between segments, and celebrate the joy of a good day on the water. Each song is made just for you on Suno. Tap to play. Add new ones any time.

Add a Suno Song

Made a song on Suno? Paste the share link here so it lives in your playlist forever.

Song Title

e.g. My Hype Song

Suno URL

<https://suno.com/s/...>

Add to Playlist

Nicolas's Kayaking Playlist

Tap any song to listen. Use them before a paddle, between segments, or after a great trip.



Make Your First Kayaking Song

Same workflow as the tennis songs. Some ideas:

1. "PFD On" — a rhythm song for the pre-paddle routine.
2. "Eyes Up, Eyes Far Across the Water" — a song about scanning the harbor.
3. "Pedal Like a Fish" — a song about the rhythm of the pedal drive.
4. "Sippican Harbor" — a song about our home water.
5. "Buzzards Bay Buddies" — a song for when Nicolas and Alexander paddle together.



How to Add a New Song

Tap the green **+ Add a Suno Song** button at the top of this panel. The app will save your songs right on this iPad — they'll be there next time too.

1. Make the song on Suno together with Nicolas/Alexander.
2. Copy the share link from Suno (the URL of the song page).
3. Tap **+ Add a Suno Song** above.
4. Enter the title, paste the URL, tap Save.

When to use the songs



On the way to practice

In the car. Builds anticipation.
Lets the body get into "kayaking mode" before arrival.



Warm-up block

Play a song while doing menu moves on the dock. The song's length signals when warm-up is done.



Between blocks

A 30-second song clip resets attention before moving to the next part of the trip.



Champion moment

End every Format C trip with a song. Pair the song with the win-feeling.



Regulation

If a moment feels hard (cold water, tip over fear, wind too strong), pause and listen to a familiar song.



Drive home

Replay the song on the way home. Pairs the music with the memory of a good paddle.

" A song is a feeling you can put in your pocket. Paddle plus music plus rhythm plus joy — that is your sport. "

— *Built with love for Nicolas* —